

Scientific Computing & Advanced Programming Lab

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Lecture-1



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Welcome!

- ▶ Slides will be available at ["https://sauravsrar.github.io/MA-5105-Aug-26/"](https://sauravsrar.github.io/MA-5105-Aug-26/)
- ▶ Codes corresponding to each lecture will be available at the same place.



Prerequisites and Demands

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- ▶ Some python programming experience
- ▶ Basic linear algebra and calculus



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Demands

- ▶ honesty: don't cheat yourself !



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- ▶ Basic linear algebra and calculus

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- ▶ clocking numerous hours per week in writing / testing codes.
- ▶ interact with me and the teaching assistant



Course Policies

Collaboration

- struggle first



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- ▶ struggle first
- ▶ discuss specific doubts over the macroscopic problem



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- ▶ don't use to solve the problem
- ▶ may be only ask for clarifications



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Assignments

- ▶ No assignments



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Assignments

- ▶ No assignments
- ▶ A lot of problem sets



Grading

- ▶ 4 surprise quizzes (fairly easy), 10 Marks each.
- ▶ 1 viva exam, 20 Marks.
- ▶ Class participation: 20 Marks.
- ▶ A final project worth 20 Marks.



Computing

- ▶ What do computers do ?



Computing

- ▶ What do computers do ?
- ▶ How do they compute ?



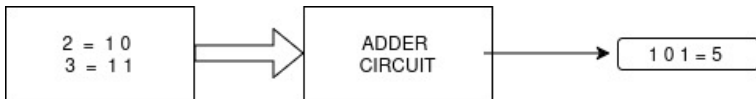
Computing

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 1. Data movement: read / store
 2. logical : Compare / And / Or
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 4. control flow: Jump to another instruction



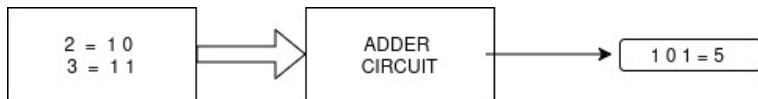
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- ▶ Example-1: Calculate $2 + 3$:



- ▶ By itself not very impressive.



Computing

Example-2:

1. Read marks of next student;
2. Add score;
3. Compute Avg;
4. Store result;



Computing

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Computing

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1. Read marks of next student;
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- ▶ the computer doesn't learn any new operation for each of the instructions
 - ▶ each operation is broken down to basic operation blocks, performed in some sequence



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- ▶ Programming is the process of organising basic operations into simple applications which combine to solve a much larger problem.



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- ▶ can compute anything using 6 primitives (Turing)
- ▶ programming language provides a set of primitive operations
- ▶ create "expressions" which are complex but legal combination of primitives
- ▶ write down a sequence of declaration / evaluation usually to meet some end goal.



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- ▶ programming language provides a set of primitive operations
- ▶ create "expressions" which are complex but legal combination of primitives
- ▶ write down a sequence of declaration / evaluation usually to meet some end goal.
- ▶ Complex software is built by combining numerous of these tiny, simple instructions into a carefully organised sequence.



What is a program?



What is a program?

Program

A program is a sequence of definitions and commands

- ▶ definitions **evaluated**
- ▶ commands **executed**



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Scripts/Shells

- ▶ can be typed directly in a shell
- ▶ typically stored in a file



Install and use Python through IDLE (Ubuntu)

▶ `python3 --version`



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- ▶ `idle-python3.12` (**start idle**)



Where things may go wrong

Syntactic errors:

- ▶ common
- ▶ easily caught by compilers
- ▶ English:
 - “sat cat mat” → not syntactically valid
 - “cat sat on the mat” → syntactically valid
- ▶ Programming Language:
 - “hi” 5 → not syntactically valid
 - $3.2 * 5$ → syntactically valid



Where things may go wrong

Static semantic errors:

- ▶ syntactically valid strings
- ▶ no semantic errors
 1. program crashes, stops running
 2. program runs forever
 3. program gives an answer but different than expected



Content

Objects

Branching and Iterations



OBJECTS

- ▶ programs manipulate data objects



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- ▶ objects have a type
 - ▶ Saurav is a human so he can breathe, sleep, etc.
 - ▶ An uncle is a relative, so he can give career advice, discuss politics, ask about your grades.
 - ▶ Mango is a fruit, so it can be ...



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 1. Scalar (cannot be subdivided)
 2. non-scalar (have internal structure that can be accessed)



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- ▶ `NoneType` - **special** and has one value, `None`



Scalar objects

- ▶ `int` - represents **integers**, e.g. 7
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- ▶ `bool` - represents **real Boolean values** True or False
- ▶ `NoneType` - **special** and has one value, None
- ▶ use `type (..)` to see the type of an object



Scalar objects

Type conversion (cast)

- ▶ can convert object of one type to another
- ▶ `float (3)` converts integer 3 to float 3.0
- ▶ `int (3.9)` truncates float 3.9 to integer 3



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Print to console

- ▶ `3 + 2`



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Print to console

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- ▶ `print (3 + 2)`



Variables

Binding Variables and values

▶ `interest = 1000.0 * 9.8 * 6 / 100.0`



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- ▶ `interest = 1000.0 * 9.8 * 6 / 100.0`
- ▶ `roi = 9.8`
- ▶ `prin = 1000.0`
- ▶ `time = 6`



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- ▶ `interest = 1000.0 * 9.8 * 6 / 100.0`
- ▶ `roi = 9.8`
- ▶ `prin = 1000.0`
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- ▶ `interest = prin * roi * time / 100.0`



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Binding Variables and values

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- ▶ `roi = 9.8`
- ▶ `prin = 1000.0`
- ▶ `time = 6`
- ▶ `interest = prin * roi * time / 100.0`
- ▶ can modify interest by modifying any of the basic components.



Math Functions and Number Methods

1. `round()`, for rounding numbers to some number of decimal places

```
▶ >>> round(2.3)
>>> round(3.14159, 3)
>>> round(2.65, 1.4)
```



Math Functions and Number Methods

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- ▶

```
>>> round(2.3)
>>> round(3.14159, 3)
>>> round(2.65, 1.4)
```

2. `abs()`, for getting the absolute value of a number

- ▶

```
>>> abs(3)
>>> abs(-5.0)
```

3. `pow()`, for raising a number to some power

- ▶

```
>>> pow(2, 3)
>>> pow(2, -2)
>>> pow(2, 3, 2)
```



Strings

- ▶ Many programmers deal with text on a daily basis
- ▶ example
 - ▶ web developers work with text that gets input from web forms
 - ▶ Data scientists process text to extract data and perform things like sentiment analysis, to classify opinions in a body of text.



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 - ▶ web developers work with text that gets input from web forms
 - ▶ Data scientists process text to extract data and perform things like sentiment analysis, to classify opinions in a body of text.
- ▶ Collections of text in Python are called strings



Strings

- ▶ letters, special characters, spaces, digits



Strings

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- ▶ enclose in

`hi = 'hello there' or`

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Strings

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```
hi = 'hello there' or
```

```
hi = "hello there" or
```

- ▶ **concatenate** strings

```
name = "saurav"
```

```
greet = hi + name
```

```
greeting = hi + " " + name
```

- ▶ **String Indexing**

```
>>> flavor = "apple pie"
```

```
>>> flavor[1]
```

```
'p'
```

- ▶ In Python—and most other programming languages—counting always starts at zero.



Strings

- ▶ To get the character at the beginning of a string, you need to access the character at position 0:

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- ▶ **String Slicing**

- ▶ Suppose you need the string containing just the first three letters of the string "apple pie".

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>>> first_three_letters = flavor[0] +  
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Strings

Strings Are Immutable

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```
>>> word = "goal"
```

```
>>> word[0] = "f"
```



Strings

Strings Are Immutable

- ▶ we can't change them once we've created them

```
>>> word = "goal"
>>> word[0] = "f"
```
- ▶ If we want to alter a string, we must create an entirely new string

Converting Strings to Numbers

- ▶ `int()` stands for integer and converts objects into whole numbers,
- ▶ `float()` stands for floating-point number and converts objects into numbers with decimal points.



Strings

Converting Numbers to Strings

- ▶ Sometimes you need to convert a number to a string.
- ▶

```
>>> num_pancakes = 10  
>>> "I am going to eat " + num_pancakes  
+ " pancakes."
```



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>>> num_pancakes = 10  
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+ " pancakes."
```
- ▶ Since `num_pancakes` is a number, Python can't concatenate it with the string "I'm going to eat".
- ▶ To build the string, you need to convert `num_pancakes` to a string using `str()`:

```
>>> num_pancakes = 10  
>>> "I am going to eat " +  
str(num_pancakes) + " pancakes."
```



Input / Output

► output

```
>>> x = 1  
>>> print(3)
```



Input / Output

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```
>>> x = 1  
>>> print(3) >>> print(5*text)
```

Interact With User Input

► input

```
>>> text = input("Type anything... ")  
>>> print (text)
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► Working With Strings and Number:

user input using the `input()` function, the result is always a string.



Content

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Comments

```
import math

principal = 500000
interest = 7.5
duration = 20

r = interest / 12 / 100
n = duration * 12

if r == 0:
    payment = principal / n
else:
    payment = principal * r * (1 + r) ** n / ((1 + r) ** n - 1)

print("Monthly EMI = ", payment, " Ruppes")
```



Comments

A person can understand the syntax, but they may wonder:



Comments

A person can understand the syntax, but they may wonder:

- ▶ Why is the interest divided by 12 and then by 100?
- ▶ Where did this complicated formula come from?
- ▶ Why is there a special case when $r == 0$?

The code works, but the intent is not obvious.



Comments

```
import math

# Loan details
principal = 500000      # Loan amount in rupees
interest = 7.5          # Annual interest rate (in percent)
duration = 20           # Loan repayment period (in years)

# Convert the annual interest rate into a monthly decimal rate,
# as the EMI formula works with monthly interest.
r = interest / 12 / 100

# Total number of monthly installments.
n = duration * 12

# If there is no interest, each installment is simply an equal
# share of the principal.
if r == 0:
    payment = principal / n
else:
    # Compute the Equated Monthly Installment (EMI) using the
    # standard loan amortization formula used by banks.
    payment = principal * r * (1 + r) ** n / ((1 + r) ** n - 1)

# Display the monthly payment amount.
print("Monthly EMI =", payment, "Rupees")
```



Comments

What the comments add

- ▶ Why the interest rate is converted.
- ▶ What n represents.
- ▶ Why there is a special case for zero interest.
- ▶ Where the formula comes from (the standard EMI formula).



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- ▶ What n represents.
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- ▶ Where the formula comes from (the standard EMI formula).
- ▶ What each input variable means.



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# Print "Hello, world"  
print("Hello, world")
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- ▶ to explain why something is done a certain way
- ▶ comments should be used sparingly
- ▶ Use comments only when they add value



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- ▶ You can also create user-defined functions that perform specific tasks.
- ▶ Functions break code into smaller chunks, and are great for tasks that a program uses repeatedly



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>>> len= "I'm not the len you're  
looking for."  
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looking for."  
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```

- ▶ Now `len` has a string value
- ▶ The variable name `len` is a keyword in Python, and even though you can change it's value, it's usually a bad idea to do so.



Functions Are Values

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- ▶ because it's easy to mistake the new `len` for the built-in function.
- ▶ If you typed in the previous code examples, you no longer have access to the built-in `len` function in IDLE.
- ▶ You can get it back with the following code:

```
>>> del len
```
- ▶ The `del` keyword is used to un-assign a variable from a value.
- ▶ `del` stands for delete, but it doesn't delete the value. Instead, it detaches the name from the value and deletes the name.



How Python Executes Functions

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- ▶ Python raises a `TypeError` when `len()` is called because `len()` expects an argument.
- ▶ An argument is a value that gets passed to the function as input.
- ▶ Some functions can be called with no arguments, and some can take as many arguments as you like.
- ▶ When a function is done executing, it returns a value as output.



How Python Executes Functions

The process for executing a function can be summarized in three steps:

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The process for executing a function can be summarized in three steps:

1. The function is called, and any arguments are passed to the function as input.
2. The function executes, and some action is performed with the arguments.
3. The function returns, and the original function call is replaced with the return value.

```
>>> num_letters = len("four")
```

- ▶ When a function changes or affects something external to the function itself, it is said to have a side effect.

```
>>> return_value= print("What do I  
return?")
```



User define Functions

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User define Functions

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The Anatomy of a Function

Every function has two parts:

1. The **function signature** defines the name of the function and any inputs it expects.



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Every function has two parts:

1. The **function signature** defines the name of the function and any inputs it expects.
2. The **function body** contains the code that runs every time the function is used.



Multiplication function

- ▶ write a function that takes two numbers as input and returns their product.

```
def multiply(x, y):    # Function
signature
    # Function body
    product = x * y
    return product
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- ▶ The first line of code in a function is called the function signature.
- ▶ It always starts with the `def` keyword, which is short for “define.”



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```

The function signature has four parts:

- ▶ The `def` keyword
- ▶ The function name, `multiply`
- ▶ The parameter list, `(x, y)`
- ▶ A colon `(:)` at the end of the line



CONTROL FLOW - BRANCHING



Indentation in Python

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age = 18

if age >= 18:
    print("Eligible to vote")

print("Program finished")
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```

- ▶ In Python, indentation is mandatory, not just a matter of style.



Indentation in Python

Incorrect Indentation

```
marks = 45
```

```
if marks >= 50:  
    print("Marks = ", marks)  
print("Pass")
```

